OPERATION TULI

March 24 – April 25, 2025

P E R P E T U A L I S T A

THE COMMUNITY OUTREACH DEPARTMENT ANNUAL REPORT

Project Manhood: EMPOWERING BOYS, BRIGHTENING FUTURES

Operation Manhood, also known as tuli, is a significant rite of passage for many Filipino boys. It's more than just a medical procedure; it's a cultural tradition signifying maturity and transition into manhood. This initiative, undertaken by the Perpetual Student Volunteers of Nightingale Promise of Care and Nightingale Society members, aims to provide this essential service to boys in need, promoting health and well-being.

The air in the Perpetual Medical Help Center in Biñan hummed with a busy energy on April 25th, 2025. A team of dedicated volunteers, the Perpetual Student Volunteers of Nightingale Promise of Care and Nightingale Society members, were preparing for Operation Manhood, a tuli program organized with the expert guidance of Ma'am Precy Lantin and Ma'am Portia Evangelista. Their faces, though focused, held a warmth that spoke volumes about their commitment to the community.

Tuli, or male circumcision, holds deep cultural significance in the Philippines. It's often seen as a rite of passage, marking a boy's transition into manhood. Beyond its cultural significance, tuli offers significant health benefits. It reduces the risk of urinary tract infections, sexually transmitted infections, and certain types of penile cancer. For boys from less privileged backgrounds, access to this procedure can be limited, highlighting the importance of initiatives like Operation Manhood.

The program commenced with a thorough briefing for both the volunteers and the boys scheduled for the procedure. Ma'am Lantin and Ma'am Evangelista ensured that all necessary

precautions were in place, emphasizing hygiene and safety protocols. The volunteers, trained meticulously beforehand, worked with precision and care, creating a calm and reassuring atmosphere. Their dedication was palpable, their actions a testament to their commitment to service.

The success of Operation Manhood wasn't solely measured by the number of boys who received the procedure. It was also about the impact on the community. The program provided not only a valuable medical service but also fostered a sense of community engagement and social responsibility. The volunteers' commitment demonstrated the power of collective action in addressing healthcare disparities and promoting the well-being of young boys in the community. By providing access to tuli, the program contributed to improved hygiene, reduced health risks, and enhanced the overall well-being of the participants. The positive ripple effect extended to families and the wider community, showcasing the transformative power of compassion and dedicated service. Operation Manhood wasn't just about circumcision; it was about empowerment, health, and the building of a stronger, healthier community.